

Interaction Design Project: Final Report

Group members:

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Website name: Etsy

Website URL: <https://www.etsy.com/>

Prototype URL: <https://3bkgwp.axshare.com/>

Executive Summary

This study aimed to evaluate the usability of the original website, Etsy, and propose enhancements to improve the overall user experience. Through rigorous testing and analysis, several shortcomings were identified, including challenges with navigation, item grouping, error message confirmation and feedback, pop ups on adding to cart or collection and the shopping experience.

The original website's navigation menu lacked efficiency, with non-pinned navigation elements and improper integration of categories with navigation causing confusion for users. Additionally, the absence of error indication during shipping information input, the inability to add multiple quantities to the cart, lack of confirmations and feedback to users, lack of consistency in payment section, incorrect link to user profile and no review analytics to help decision making.

To address these issues, a series of redesign adjustments were implemented. These improvements included integrating category access into the primary navigation bar and making it sticky on top, introducing a rating summary section for informed decision-making, balancing the layout of item details and ratings to enhance readability, and adding a quantity selection option for easier purchase customization. Furthermore, proper validation for card details, consistent option styles for gift card redemption, and improved navigation to user profiles, proper confirmations and feedback were implemented to streamline the purchasing journey.

To assess the effectiveness of these enhancements, twelve users participated in testing, with six individuals evaluating the original version and the remaining six testing the updated version. The results indicate significant improvements in user satisfaction and comprehension of the website's structure.

Overall, the implemented redesign adjustments have substantially enhanced the usability and efficiency of the Etsy website, making it easier for users to navigate, make informed purchase decisions, and interact with the platform. These enhancements signify a commitment to continuously improving the user experience and fostering a more seamless shopping journey for all users.

Methodology

Who we Tested

We have successfully tested the Etsy website with 12 individuals with the below demographics of the user.

Audience

Master's students	9
Working Professionals	3

Age group

18 - 24	11
24 +	1

Computer usage per week

0 - 12 hrs/week	0
12 - 24 hrs/week	1
24 + hrs/week	11

Gender

Male	10
Female	2

What participants did

We divided the 12 participants into two groups: one that tests the original website and the one that tests the modified website. We were first given a demographic form to fill and after we had received responses. We presented the task 1 prompt and made sure they followed the prompt given. Followed by task 2 and finally task 3. Later we thanked them for the time and presented the two forms to fill to collect the experiences of the user. One such form is the post session survey form and the other is usability survey.

Beginning to ending steps:

1) Login with the credentials and go to on to add 2 cotton cushion pads to the cart and add them to favorites after seeing the rating of them, Navigate back to the home page and then in

categories select a puzzle toy from wall decor sub category with Name be Harsha, 1 standard + engraving ,make sure it is 3 pegs and finally add to cart.

2) Go to the check out page and remove the puzzle and check out the order and fill in the details and then redeem the coupon prompt.

3) Navigate to the home page and check for the rating again given by any user and see his profile. Upon seeing his profile block the user and try to follow him again, and see how it behaves.

Task 1 : Add products wanted to cart

You want to add 2 “Cotton cushion chair pads” to cart from the home and living category and home decor section by reviewing the rating summary and adding it to collection-favorites. Also, add “Personalized name puzzle with pegs in wall decor” with below personalization options to cart by reviewing the item details

Task 2: Remove the products that no longer needed and checkout

Remove the “Personalized name puzzle with pegs wall decor” from the cart page and make sure it's removed. Then, check out and add the below given invalid card number in payment details. Also, enter the coupon code.

Task 3: Check profile and see the user profile behavior.

Navigate to the home page and view your profile and navigate back to “Cotton cushion chair pads”, go through reviews and block the first reviewed user and follow the same blocked user.

Metrics Collected

1. Time taken by the participants to complete each task:

Table 1: Time taken by participants who used original website

Participants / Tasks	Task 1			Task 2			Task 3			Total Task Time
	Start Time	End Time	Task Time	Start Time	End Time	Task Time	Start Time	End Time	Task Time	
Participant 1	1:58	5:43	3:45	5:45	6:55	1:10	6:48	08:01	1:13	06:08
Participant 2	3:55	8:08	4:13	8:10	9:50	1:40	10:00	11:31	1:31	07:24
Participant 3	3:15	7:40	4:25	7:51	9:51	2:00	10:10	12:20	2:10	08:35
Participant	4:20	8:30	4:10	8:42	10:22	1:40	10:30	12:11	01:41	7:31

Participants / Tasks	Task 1			Task 2			Task 3			Total Task Time
	Start Time	End Time	Task Time	Start Time	End Time	Task Time	Start Time	End Time	Task Time	
4										
Participant 5	3:50	8:19	4:29	8:45	10:25	1:40	10:45	11:59	1:14	07:23
Participant 6	3:55	7:50	3:55	7:58	9:40	1:42	9:45	11:38	1:53	07:30

Table 2: Time taken by participants who used redesigned website

Participants / Tasks	Task 1			Task 2			Task 3			Total Task Time
	Start Time	End Time	Task Time	Start Time	End Time	Task Time	Start Time	End Time	Task Time	
Participant 1	00:00	02:56	02:56	02:57	4:30	01:33	04:36	05:19	00:43	05:12
Participant 2	00:00	03:33	03:33	04:25	05:25	1:00	05:25	06:28	1:03	05:36
Participant 3	00:00	02:41	02:41	02:42	03:49	01:07	04:20	05:22	01:02	04:50
Participant 4	01:44	04:31	02:47	05:36	06:35	00:59	06:41	07:35	00:54	04:40
Participant 5	01:58	04:08	03:10	05:45	06:55	01:10	07:00	08:10	01:10	05:30
Participant 6	02:02	05:00	02:58	05:45	06:40	00:55	06:55	07:58	01:03	04:56

2. Post session review:

- 2.1. On a scale of 1 to 7. How clear are the overall instructions for the task? (1 being unclear and 7 being clear)
- 2.2. On a scale of 1 to 7, how easy was it to use the navigation bar (1 being hard and 7 * being easy)?
- 2.3. On a scale of 1 to 7, how straightforward and informative did you find the summary of ratings and reviews before making a purchase? (1 being not easy or informative, and 7 being very easy and informative)

- 2.4. On a scale of 1 to 7, how disruptive was the excessive white space caused by the * expanded item details section? (1 indicating highly distracting, and 7 indicating not distracting at all)
- 2.5. How crucial is it to you, on a scale from 1 to 7, to have a confirmation popup when * deleting items from your shopping cart? (1 indicating low importance, and 7 indicating high importance)
- 2.6. On a scale of 1 to 7, how intuitive did you find the access to product categories through the small icon (1 being not intuitive at all and 7 being very intuitive)?
- 2.7. On a scale of 1 to 7, how easy is it for you to select the quantity before placing an order? (1 being not easy at all and 7 very easy)?
- 2.8. On a scale of 1 to 7, how effective is the validation of preventing alphabets in the * card number and CVV fields for you? (1 being not effective and 7 being highly effective)
- 2.9. On a scale of 1 to 7, how easy is it to access the user profile section (1 being not easy at all and 7 very easy)?
- 2.10. On a scale of 1 to 7, How satisfying is it to redeem a coupon code in the checkout * page (1 being not satisfying at all and 7 being very Satisfying)?
- 2.11. On a scale of 1 to 7, how effective is it to block a user (1 not effective and 7 being very effective at all)?
- 2.12. On a scale of 1 to 7. How clear are the overall instructions for the task? (1 being unclear and 7 being clear)
- 2.13. On a scale of 1 to 7. rate the overall similarity of the website to other well known E- commerce websites (1 being different and 7 being similar)
- 2.14. On a scale of 1 to 7. Rate your overall experience with the pages you interacted with (1 being extremely unpleasant and 7 being very pleasant)

Table 3: Post session review responses
(Color orange being the Original Website. Green being the Redesigned Website.)

	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5	Q6	Q7	Q8	Q9	Q10	Q11	Q12	Q13	Q14	Total Rating
Participant 1	6	3	2	1	2	1	2	4	3	3	3	6	4	3	43
Participant 2	7	2	3	2	4	3	4	2	5	3	4	7	5	3	54
Participant 3	7	2	3	2	1	3	2	1	1	2	2	7	3	1	37
Participant 4	7	6	6	2	1	3	2	3	5	5	3	7	1	3	54
Participant 5	7	5	6	4	6	4	7	1	6	3	1	7	2	5	64

Participant 6	7	3	2	1	2	3	2	3	1	2	3	7	2	3	41
Participant 7	7	6	7	6	5	6	7	6	7	6	6	7	6	6	88
Participant 8	6	7	5	7	6	6	7	6	7	7	6	6	6	7	89
Participant 9	7	6	7	6	7	6	7	7	7	7	7	7	6	7	94
Participant 10	7	6	7	6	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	6	6	94
Participant 11	7	6	6	6	7	6	7	6	7	6	6	7	6	6	89
Participant 12	7	7	7	7	7	6	6	7	6	7	6	7	7	7	94

3. Number of clicks:

Table 3: Number of clicks used by each participant
(Color orange being the Original Website. Green being the Redesigned Website.)

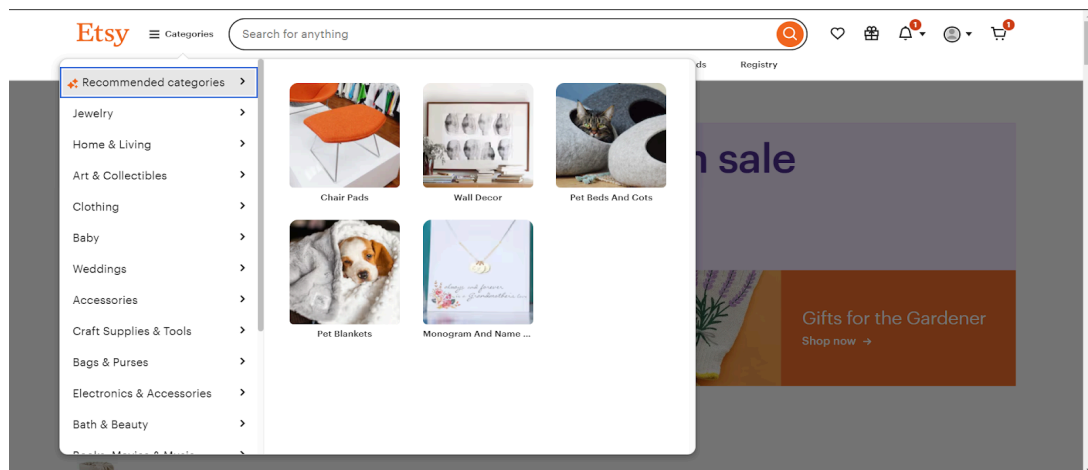
Participants	Task 1	Task 2	Task 3	Total number of clicks
Participant 1	23	10	9	42
Participant 2	22	10	8	40
Participant 3	25	11	10	46
Participant 4	22	12	10	44
Participant 5	22	10	9	41
Participant 6	23	10	11	44
Participant 7	19	8	7	34
Participant 8	18	8	8	34
Participant 9	19	8	8	35
Participant 10	17	9	9	35
Participant 11	18	9	7	34
Participant 12	20	9	9	38

Improvements

1. Redesigned Navigation Menu:

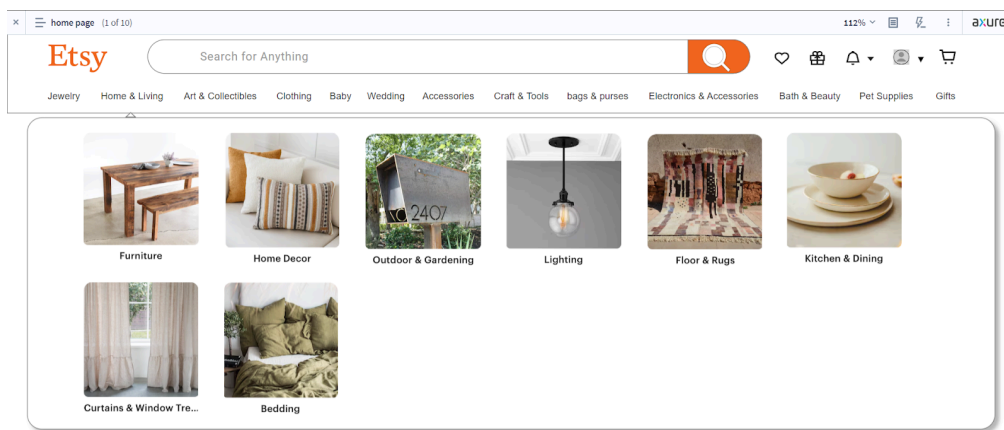
Original Website Design:

The original design of Etsy features access to categories through a small icon located to the left of the navigation bar. The utilization of a small icon, distinct from the navbar, fails to seamlessly integrate category access with the primary navigation structure of the website and The top navigation bar on the platform is not sticky and does not move with scrolling. This lack of stickiness makes it difficult for users to navigate through pages, as they have to scroll back to the top each time they want to access the navigation menu. and diminishes overall user navigation efficiency.



Redesigned Website:

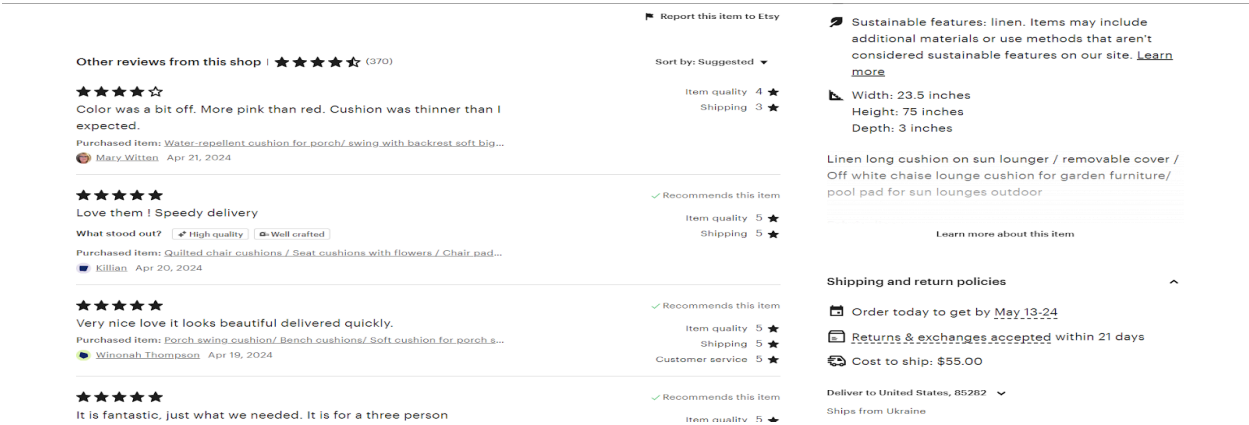
In the redesigned version of Etsy, The category access has been seamlessly integrated into the primary navigation structure of the website, categories are now prominently displayed within the navbar itself and the top navigation bar has been made sticky, ensuring that it remains visible and accessible at all times as users scroll through the page, enhancing user experience, thereby improving overall user navigation efficiency.



2. Added Rating Summary

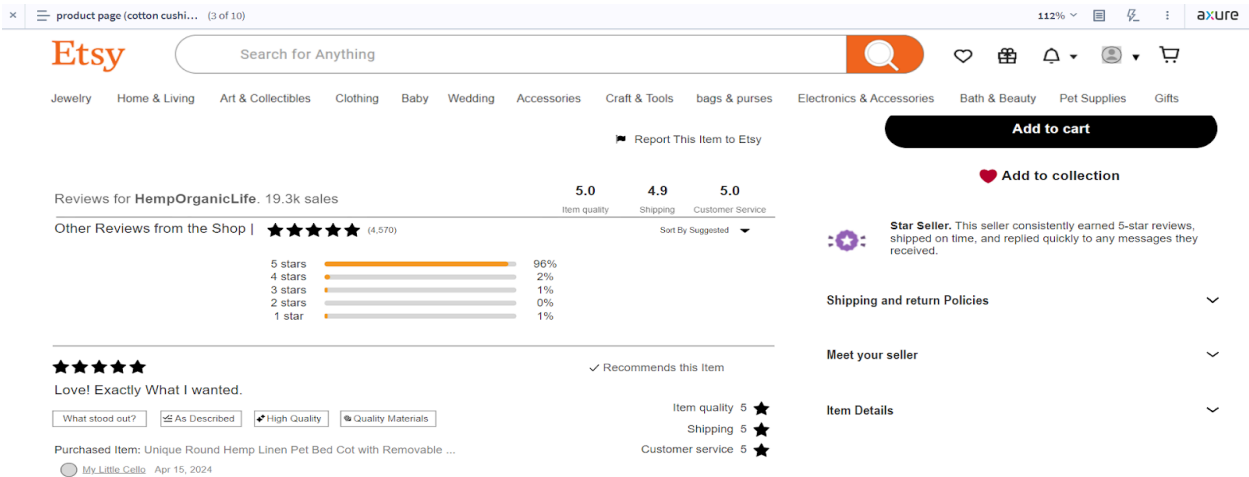
Original Website:

In the original design of the product page on Etsy, rating summary is absent. Despite individual reviews provided by different users for each product, there is no section displaying a summary or analytics on these reviews. This absence of a rating summary deprives users of valuable information that could assist them in making informed decisions about their chosen product.



Redesigned Website:

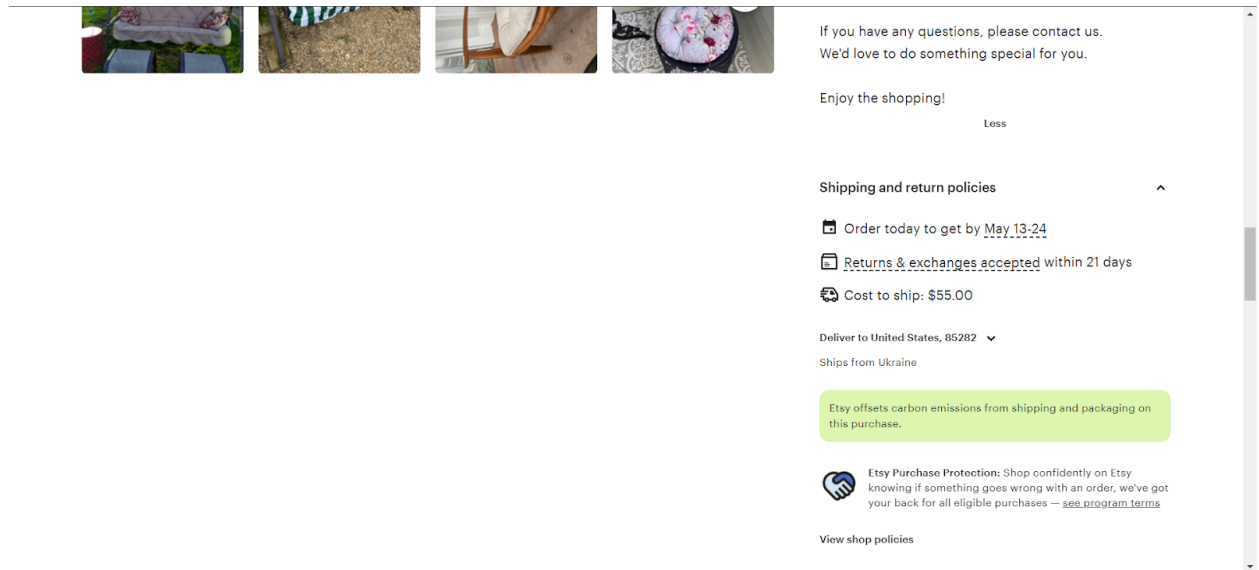
In the redesigned version of the product page. A rating summary section has been added, displaying analytics and summaries of the reviews provided by different users. This enhancement provides users with valuable insights into the overall quality and reception of the product, empowering them to make more informed purchasing decisions.



3. Added Scrollbar to Item Details Section

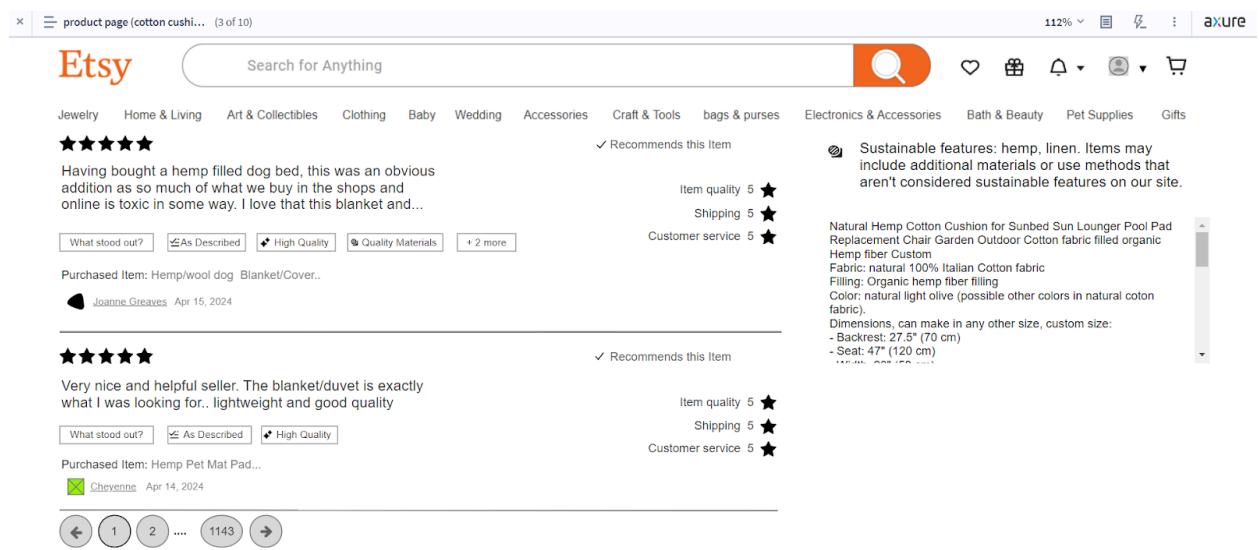
Original Website:

Expanding the item details section on Etsy results in significant whitespace on the left side of the page. The imbalance created by this whitespace could disrupt users' ability to effectively process information.



Redesigned Website:

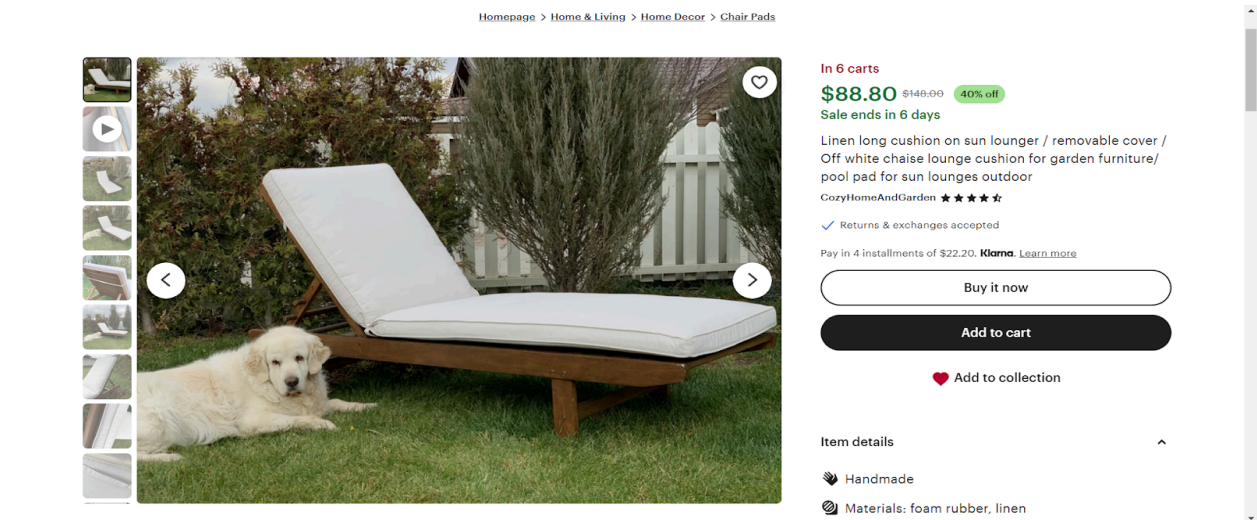
In the redesigned version of the item details section, The expanded item details now occupy a more balanced layout, minimizing whitespace on the left side of the page.



4. Added Option to select Quantity before adding to cart

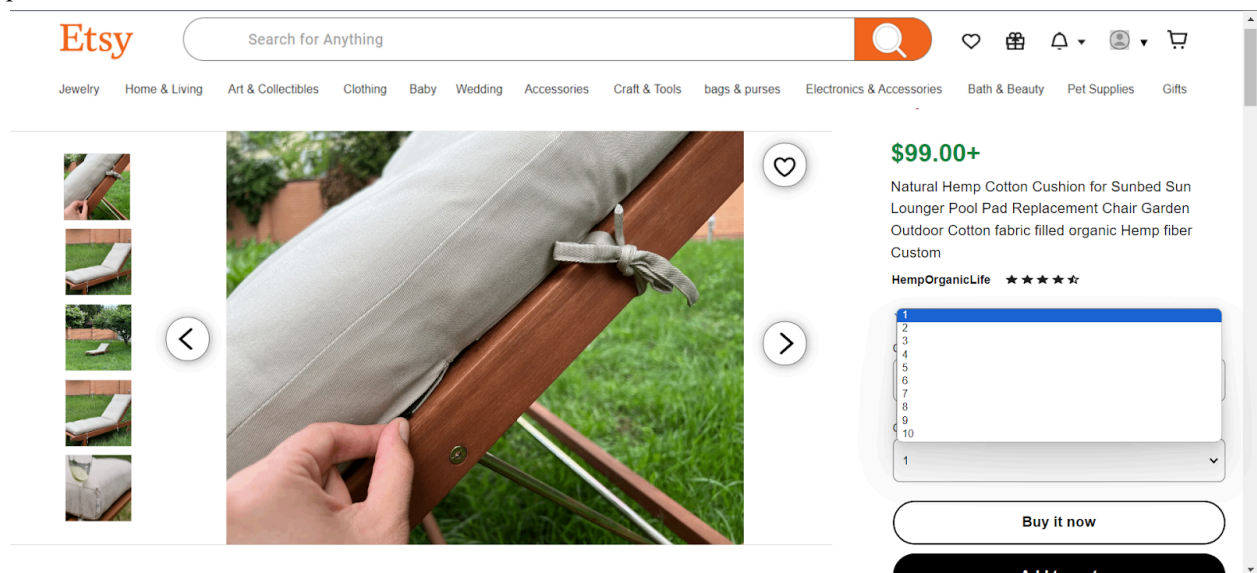
Original Website:

In the original design, there is no option to select the quantity of the item before placing the order. This absence of a quantity input option hampers users' ability to accurately indicate how many units of the item they intend to purchase.



Redesigned Website:

In the redesigned version, a quantity dropdown option has been added to address this issue. Users can now select the desired quantity of the item before proceeding to place their order. This enhancement improves the user experience by allowing users to specify the exact number of units they wish to purchase.



5. Added Proper Validation for card details in checkout page

Original Website:

On the checkout page of Etsy, the validation of the card details form is not proper. Users are allowed to enter alphabets in fields such as the card number and CVV fields. Users expect the form to restrict inputs to valid characters and formats, providing immediate feedback when incorrect information is entered.

Choose a payment method

You will not be charged until you review this order on the next page.

☒ Card 

Name on card *
Make sure to enter the full name that's on your card.

Card number *

Expiration date * **Security code ***

☒ My billing address is the same as my shipping address:
Rishi Krishna, 34567, TEMPE, AZ 85282, United States, 623-290-3399

☒ Set as default

[Review your order](#)

Redesigned Website:

In the redesigned checkout page, improvements have been made to the validation of the card details form. The form now properly restricts inputs to valid characters and formats, preventing users from entering alphabets in fields such as the card number and CVV fields.

Choose a payment method

You will not be charged until you review this order on the next page.

☒ 

Name on card *
Make sure to enter the full name that's on your card.

Card number *

Expiration date * **Security code ***

☒ My billing address is the same as my shipping address:
Harsha Vardhan Reddy Kuncha, 1440 E Broadway Rd, TEMPE, AZ 85282-1639, United States, 630-232-6793

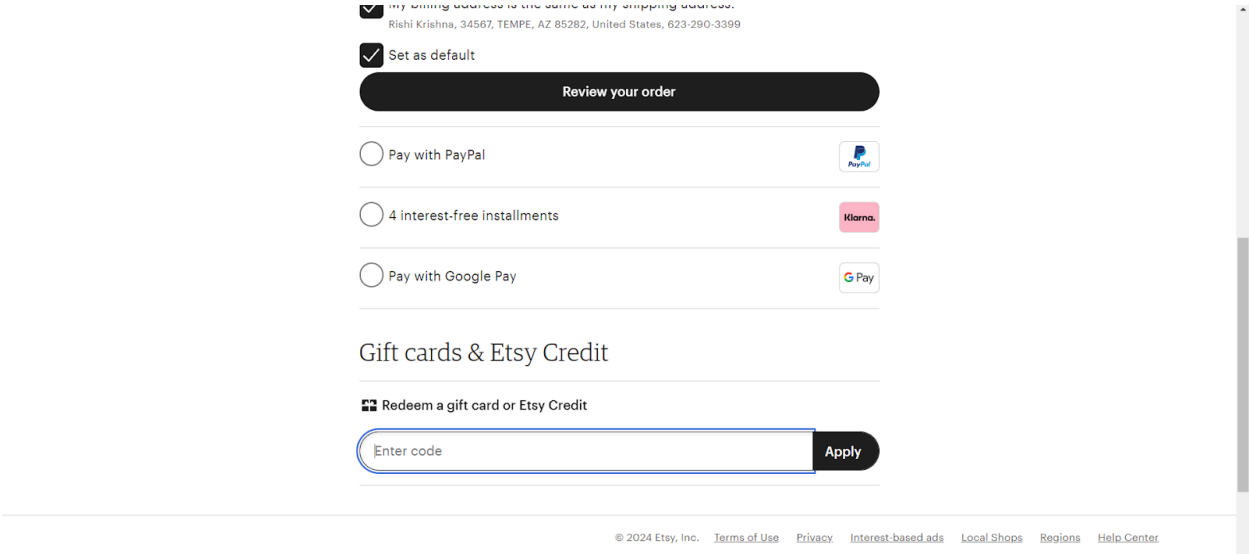
☒ Set as default

[Review your order](#)

6. Changed Option style for Redemption of Gift Cards

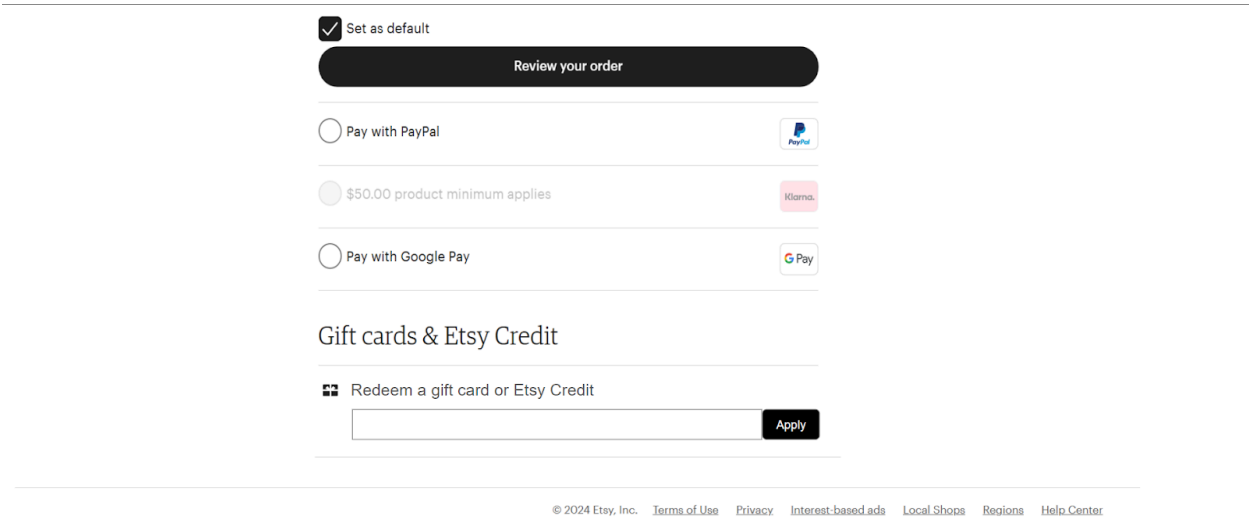
Original Website:

On the payment methods page of Etsy, the redemption process for gift cards lacks consistency as methods typically involve checkboxes or straightforward selection mechanisms, the redemption process for gift cards does not follow the same style.



Redesigned Website:

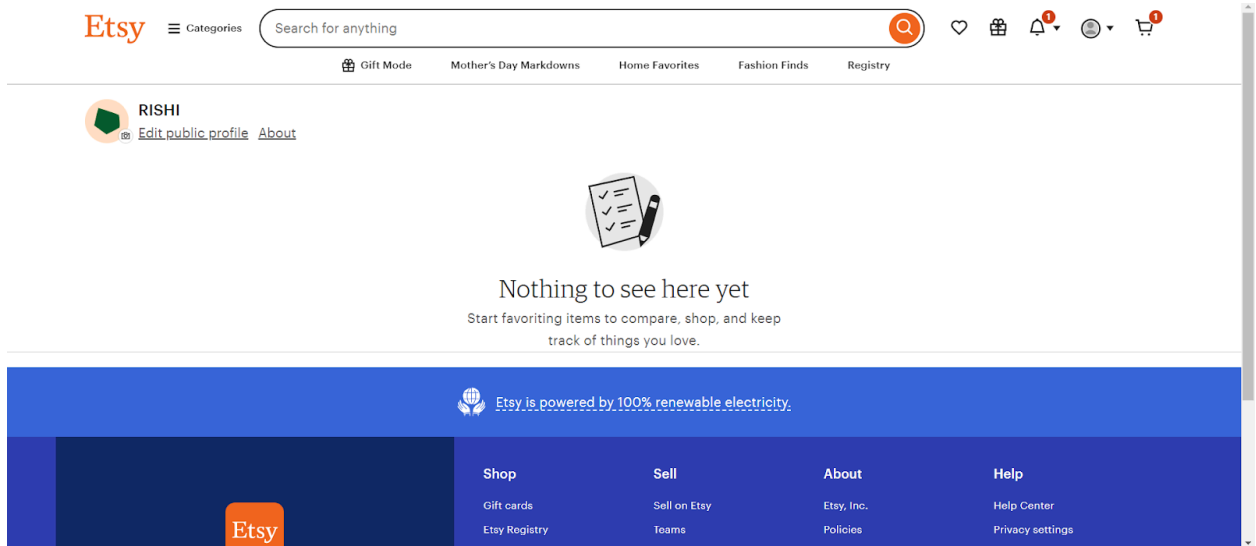
In the redesigned payment methods page, the redemption process for gift cards has been updated to ensure consistency with other options. Now, the redemption process follows the same style as other payment methods, involving checkboxes or straightforward selection mechanisms.



7. Corrected Misleading Navigation to User Profile

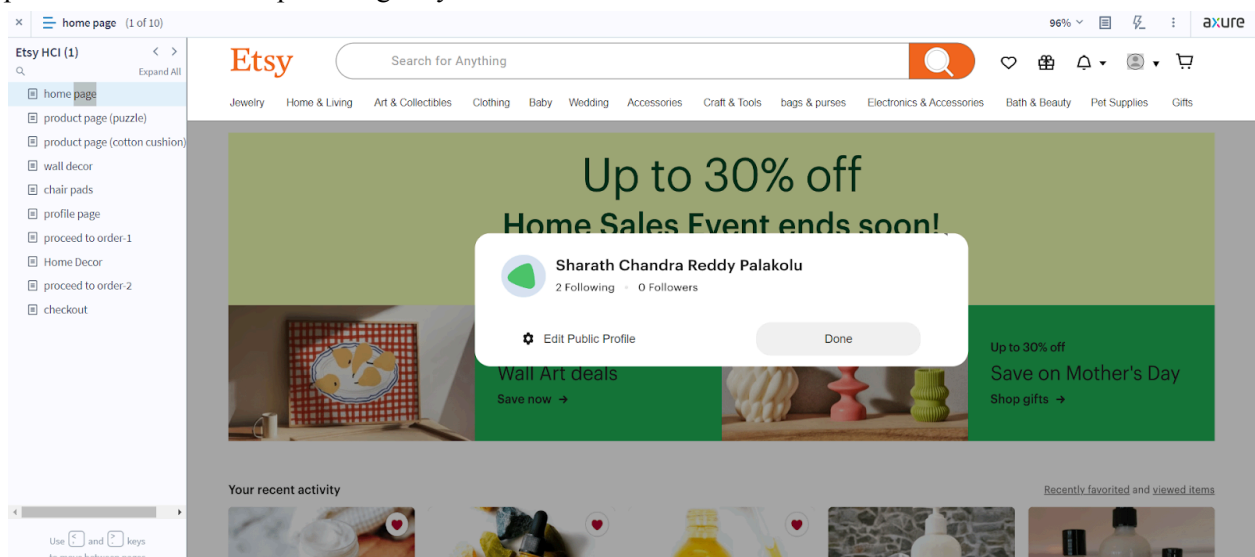
Original Website:

On the platform, when users attempt to view their profile, they are directed to a page displaying their favorites instead of their profile details. Users anticipate direct access to their profile details, including the ability to edit their information if necessary.



Redesigned Website:

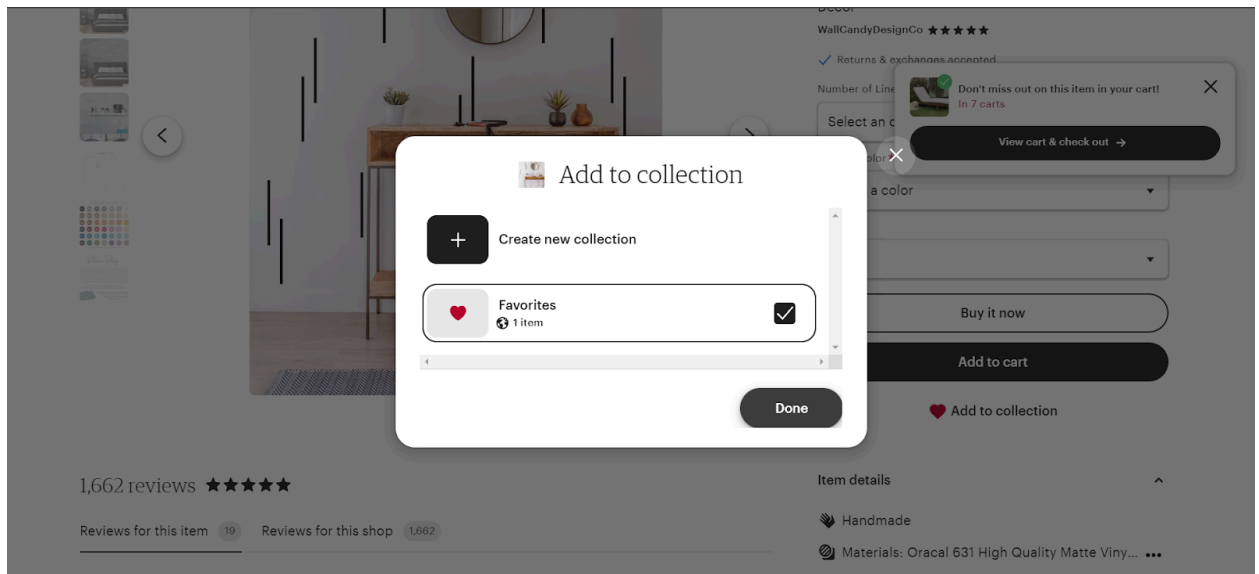
In the redesigned version of the platform, improvements have been made to the navigation to the user profile. Now, when users intend to view their profile, they are directly routed to a pop-up displaying their profile details and also providing easy access to edit their information if needed.



8. Added Confirmation Message After Adding to Collection

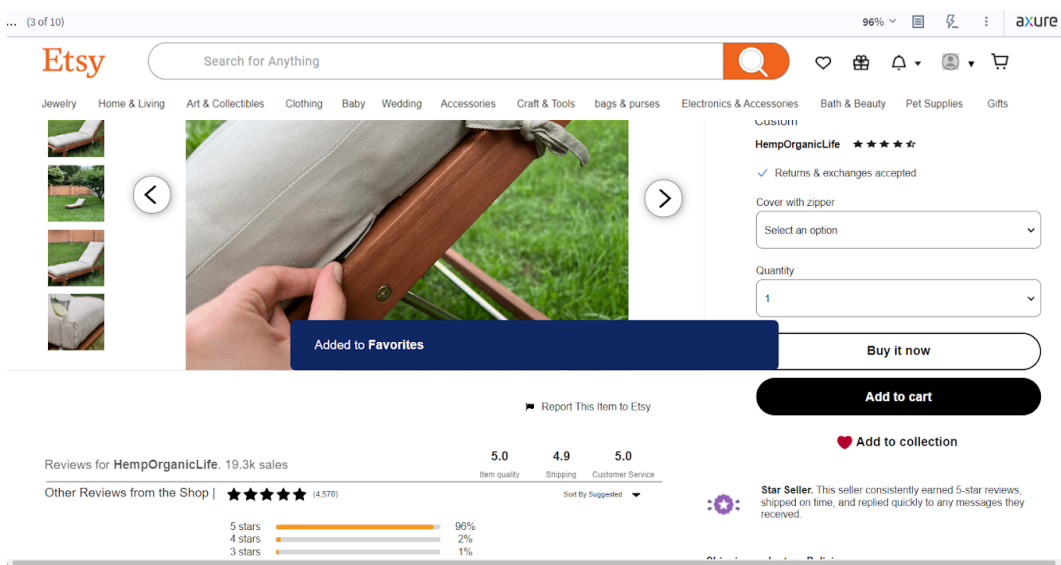
Original Website:

On the platform, when users click the "add to collection" button, the item is successfully added to their collection. However, the interface does not provide any confirmation message or feedback to indicate that the action was successful. This absence of feedback leaves users unsure if their action was completed successfully.



Redesigned Website:

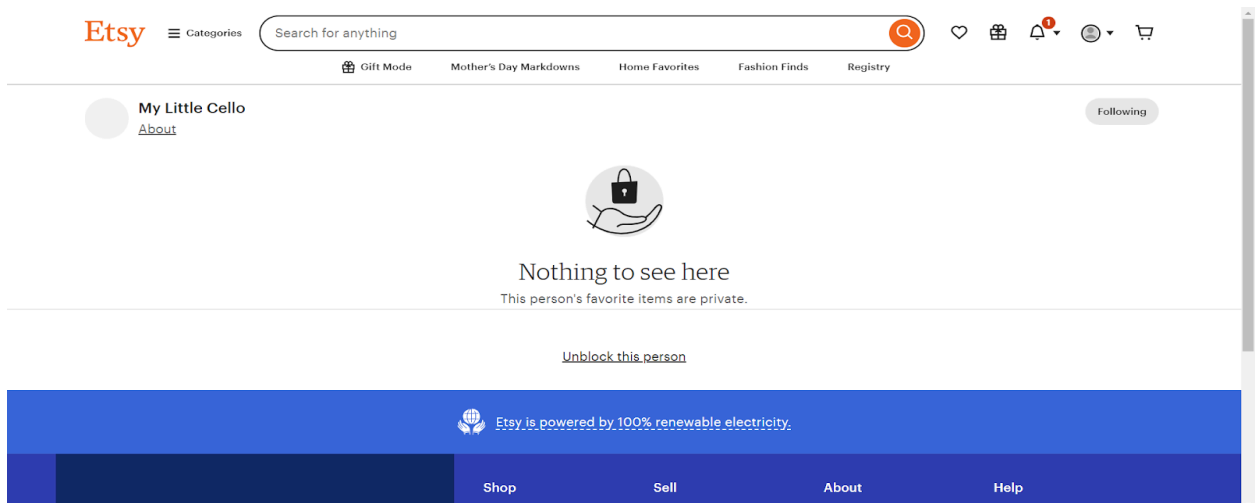
In the redesigned version of the platform, a confirmation message has been implemented after adding an item to the collection. Now, when users click the "add to collection" button, they receive immediate feedback confirming that the item has been successfully added to their collection.



9. Made Blocking Functionality Effective

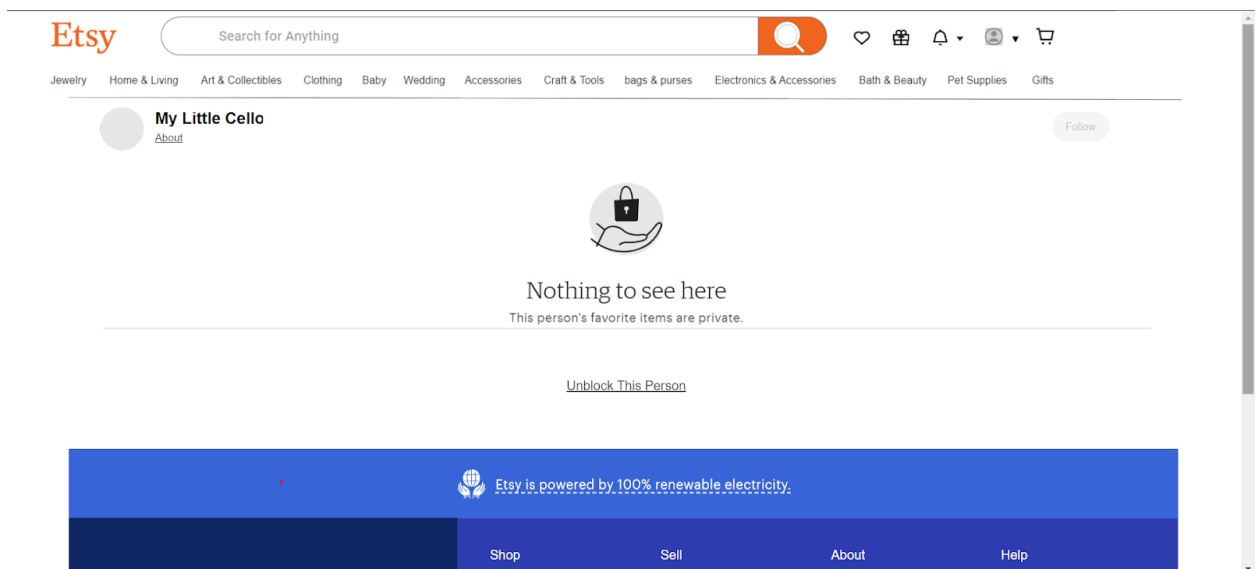
Original Website Design:

The platform's blocking functionality allows users to block other users, including reviewers. However, even when a user blocks a reviewer, the user still maintains the ability to follow the reviewer. This ineffective blocking functionality undermines the purpose of the blocking feature and potentially leads to continued unwanted interactions.



Redesigned Website:

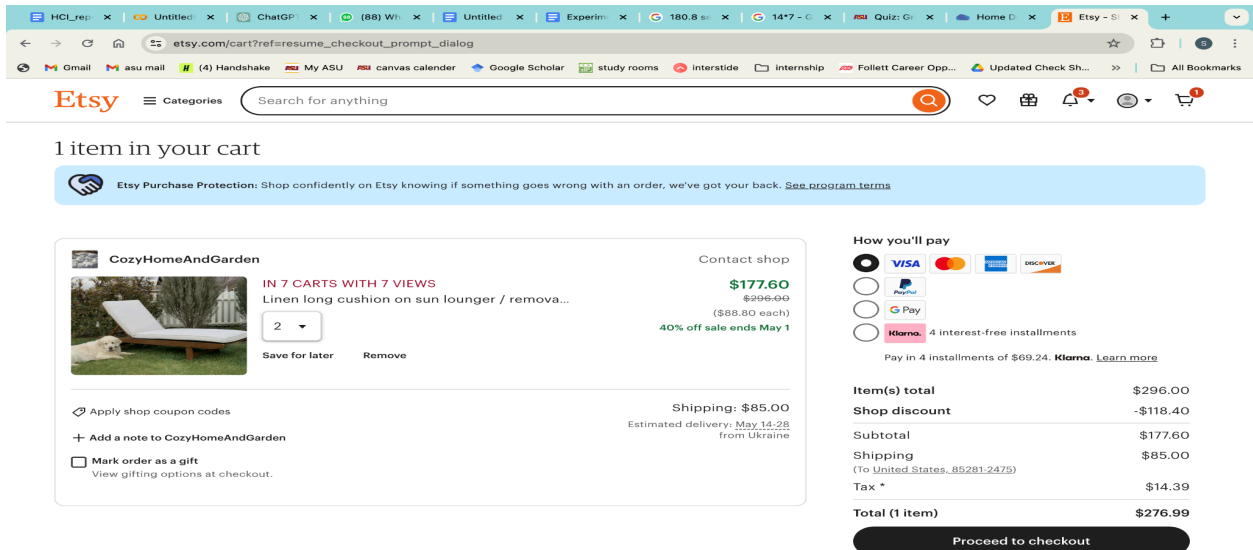
In the redesigned version of the platform, improvements have been made to the blocking functionality. Now, when a user blocks another reviewer, the blocked user's ability to interact with the follow button is fully restricted.



10. Added confirmation popup while removing an item from the cart

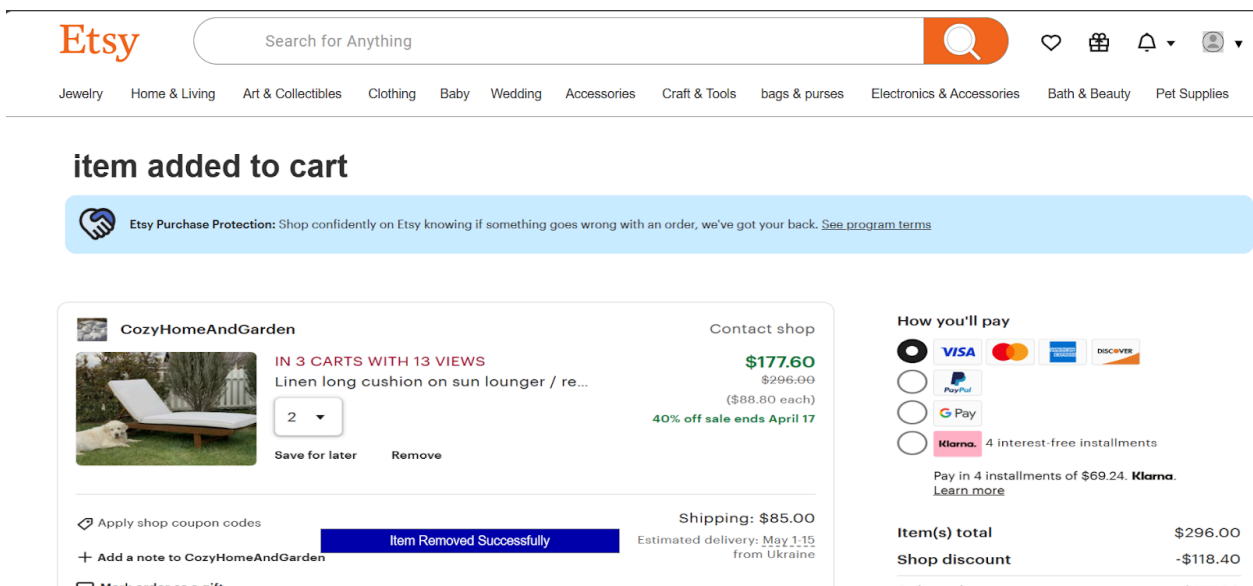
Original Website Design:

The shopping cart feature on the original website lacks a confirmation popup when users attempt to delete an item from their cart. Users anticipate a confirmation prompt before deleting items to prevent accidental actions and to receive feedback on their actions.



Redesigned Website with Changes Made:

In the redesigned version of the platform, a confirmation popup has been implemented when users attempt to delete items from their shopping cart. With this popup in place, users can proceed with confidence, knowing that their actions are confirmed and acknowledged by the system.



Overall Findings & Recommendations

1. Time Taken

<u>T-Test Scores for Task 1:</u> <i><u>Time Taken</u></i> Mean of the original website: 04:09 Mean of the redesigned website: 03:00 SD of the original website: 00:15 SD of the redesigned website:00:17 $t = 6.6712$ $p = 0.00005$	<u>T-Test Scores for Task 2:</u> <i><u>Time Taken</u></i> Mean of the original website: 01:38 Mean of the redesigned website: 1:07 SD of the original website: 00:14 SD of the redesigned website:00:12 $t = 3.6304$ $p = 0.0046$
<u>T-Test Scores for Task 3:</u> <i><u>Time Taken</u></i> Mean of the original website: 01:37 Mean of the redesigned website: 00:59 SD of the original website: 00:20 SD of the redesigned website: 00:08 $t = 3.8186$ $p = 0.00338$	<u>T-Test Scores for Total Tasks:</u> <i><u>Time Taken</u></i> Mean of the original website: 07:25 Mean of the redesigned website: 05:07 SD of the original website: 00:42 SD of the redesigned website: 00:20 $t = 6.51488$ $p = 0.00006$

2. Number of Clicks

<u>T-Test Scores for Task 1:</u> <i><u>Clicks</u></i> Mean of the original website:23 Mean of the redesigned website: 19 SD of the original website: 1 SD of the redesigned website: 1 t =6.7583 p = 0.00005	<u>T-Test Scores for Task 2:</u> <i><u>Clicks</u></i> Mean of the original website: 10.5 Mean of the redesigned website:8.5 SD of the original website: 0.76 SD of the redesigned website: 0.5 t = 4.8989 p = 0.00062
<u>T-Test Scores for Task 3:</u> <i><u>Clicks</u></i> Mean of the original website: 9.5 Mean of the redesigned website: 8 SD of the original website: 0.95 SD of the redesigned website: 0.81 t = 2.6655 p = 0.02367	<u>T-Test Scores for Total Clicks:</u> <i><u>Clicks</u></i> Mean of the original website: 42.833 Mean of the redesigned website: 35 SD of the original website: 2.03 SD of the redesigned website: 1.41 t = 7.0694 p = 0.000034

3. T-test scores for Post-Session Survey:

Mean of original website: 49

Mean of redesigned website:91.33

SD of original website: 9.57

SD of redesigned website: 2.687

t = 9.5190

p = 0.000002

Recommendations:

Finding	Recommendation
Navigation Bar is not visible when scrolled down and all product categories are not available directly on the navigation menu itself, the user has to click on the icon to see the menu. This Increases cognitive load.	Made the navigation bar sticky on top and integrated all categories on the navigation bar directly.
The product page shows individual reviews, but lacks a summary or analytics of these reviews, not enabling users to gain an overall insight.	Added the rating summary, which shows the percentage of different rating levels helping purchase decisions.
White space in the left half of the product page below ratings due to the large item details section on right.	Added scrollable items section removing white spaces.
No field to add quantity in product page, hindering users ability to buy multiple items at once.	Added a quantity section, enabling users to add quantity and checkout multiple items at once.
No proper validation in the payment page letting users enter invalid details.	Added Proper Validation mechanisms and feedback to let users know in case they enter invalid details.
The gift card section in payment lacks consistency with other payment methods.	The section is made consistent with other payment method designs letting users understand it belongs to the same payment options.
Misleading links to userprofile.	The links are corrected as necessary.
Lack of confirmation messages and popups at some places.	Added confirmation messages and feedback wherever necessary.
Blocking a user in the website is ineffective and is still allowed to follow blocked users.	Made the Blocking functionality effective and disabled follow feature once blocked.